Exploration of Economic Trends in South Asia Across Major Crises

Christina Dai, Tina Piltner, Joe Xia, Kenneth He

Exploration of Economic Trends in South Asia Across Major Crises

Authors: Christina Dai (2585695), Kenneth He (2724494), Tina Piltner (2615282), Joe Xia (2608991), Eric Wang (2608963)

Introduction

This project examines how major global crises affected economic conditions across South Asia by comparing trends in employment ratio, GDP growth, and GDP per capita for Bangladesh, Bhutan, India, Sri Lanka, Maldives, Nepal, and Pakistan. The analysis compares regional patterns surrounding the 1997 Asian Financial Crisis, the 2008 global financial crisis, and the COVID-19 pandemic in order to evaluate how different types of shocks affected economic performance and recovery across selected South Asian countries.

Description of topic and main findings

Summary of main findings

Data Description

Clear introduction of dataset and context

Data merging steps

Data cleaning and pre-processing

Summary of key variables (columns)

Data Analysis

Interpretation of main results and trends

Well-formatted tables and plots

Average Economic Indicators by Country and Period

country_name	period	gdp_per_capita	gdp_growth_pct	employment_ratio
Bangladesh	Crisis	866.46	6.01	55.7
Bangladesh	Post-crisis	946.99	5.69	56.02
Bangladesh	Pre-crisis	781.38	6.76	55.83
Bhutan	Crisis	2017.76	4.53	66.98
Bhutan	Post-crisis	2359.93	9.36	66.02
Bhutan	Pre-crisis	1761.8	9.56	67.24
India	Crisis	1086.51	3.09	52.2
India	Post-crisis	1223.96	7.2	50.66
India	Pre-crisis	1008.4	7.88	53.94
Maldives	Crisis	9396.5	8.98	46.97
Maldives	Post-crisis	8629.58	2.43	47.06
Maldives	Pre-crisis	8231.93	6.53	48.57
Nepal	Crisis	666.87	6.1	36.67
Nepal	Post-crisis	718.76	4.26	36.57
Nepal	Pre-crisis	617.97	3.42	36.8
Pakistan	Crisis	1258.05	2.12	49.87
Pakistan	Post-crisis	1262.53	2.55	50.43
Pakistan	Pre-crisis	1236.84	5.92	49.89
Sri Lanka	Crisis	2708.59	5.95	50.95
Sri Lanka	Post-crisis	3004.22	6.74	50.61
Sri Lanka	Pre-crisis	2422.86	6.9	50.57

Figure 1: Table of all average economic indicators for each country by period

1997 Asian Financial Crisis:

2008 Global Financial Crisis:

The 2008 global financial crisis affected South Asian economies differently across employment, output growth, and income levels. The following figures summarize trends in employment ratio, GDP growth, GDP per capita, and average crisis-period comparisons across the selected countries.

Figure 2 shows employment ratio percentages for seven South Asian countries from 2005 to 2012, with a shaded region to mark the 2008–2009 financial crisis. Based on the figure, employment ratios were relatively stable across most South Asian countries during the 2008 crisis period. Bhutan remained the highest throughout despite a later decline, India and Maldives experienced more noticeable drops around and after the crisis period, while Bangladesh, Sri Lanka, Pakistan, and Nepal stayed comparatively steady with only modest fluctuations.

Figure 2: Employment ratio trends surrounding the 2008 financial crisis

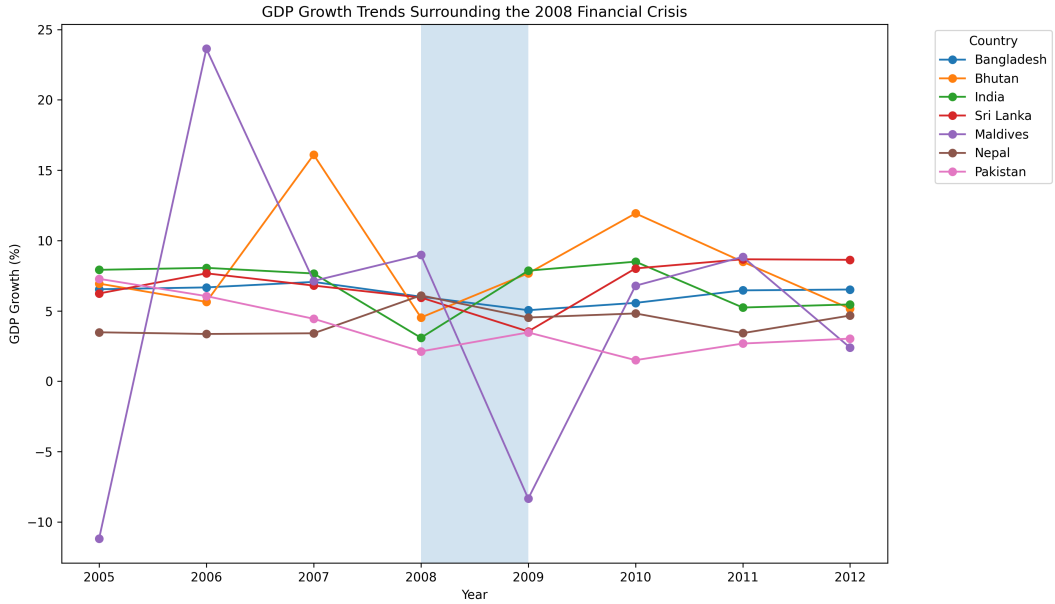

Figure 3: GDP growth trends surrounding the 2008 financial crisis

Figure 3 tracks the annual GDP growth percentages for South Asian countries from 2005 to 2012, using a shaded region to highlight the economic impact of the 2008–2009 financial crisis. The data shows that while most of these nations maintained positive growth despite a general slowdown during the crisis window, the Maldives exhibited extreme volatility and dropped sharply into negative growth in 2009.

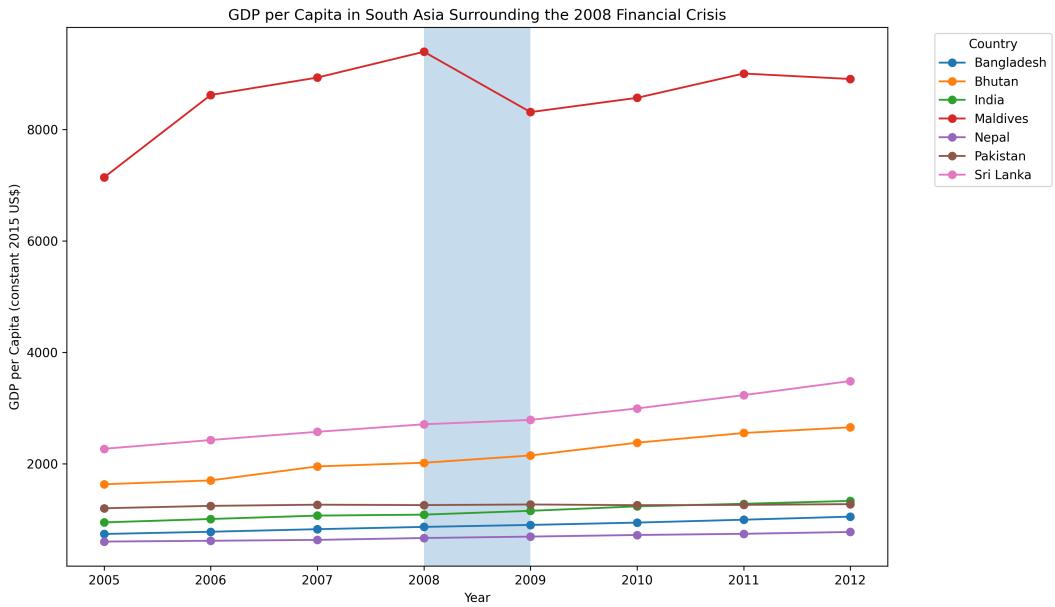

Figure 4: GDP per capita trends surrounding the 2008 financial crisis

Figure 4 illustrates the GDP per capita for South Asian nations from 2005 to 2012. The Maldives had significantly higher GDP per capita than the other countries and suffered a distinct decline during the 2008 financial crisis. However, the other economies remained relatively steady.

Figure 5 compares average GDP growth before, during, and after the 2008 crisis. The crisis affected South Asian countries unevenly. Bhutan, India, Pakistan, and Sri Lanka experienced lower average growth during the crisis than in the pre-crisis period, while Maldives and Nepal show higher crisis-period averages, indicating variation in economic resilience and recovery.

COVID-19 Pandemic:

Results and Discussion

Clarity, conciseness, and relevance of discussion

Reflection on findings and any limitations

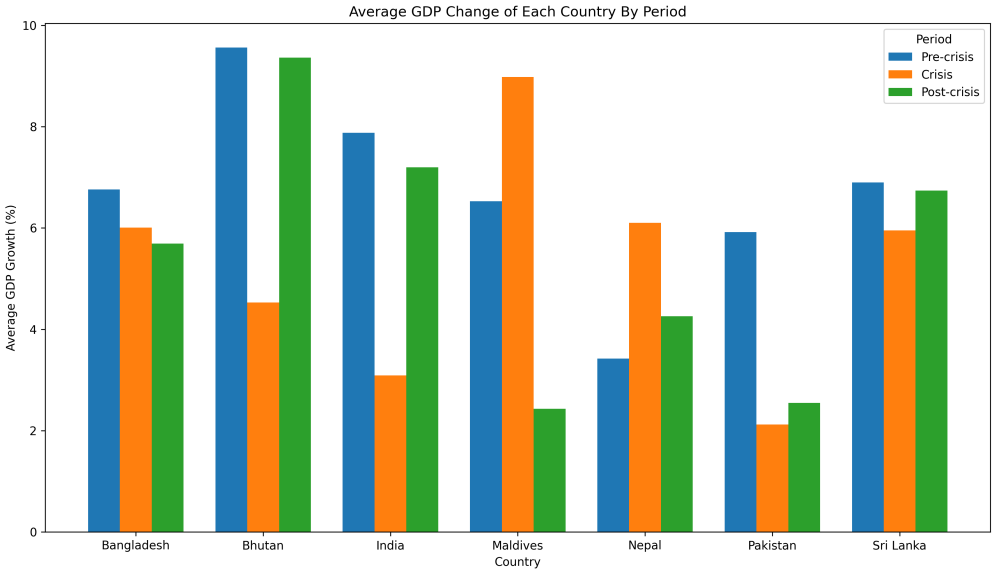

Figure 5: Average economic indicators during the 2008 crisis period

Conclusion